

Prologue

(The curtains rise to reveal the ride logo.)

NARRATOR (REX ALLEN)

Welcome to Walt Disney's Carousel of Progress. You're in for a real treat. The Carousel of Progress was Walt's own idea from beginning to end. He loved it. He introduced the show at the World's Fair in New York City in 1964 and it was an immediate smash hit. Millions of people came to see it and since then, the Carousel of Progress has had more performances than any other stage show in the history of American theater. You know, Walt loved the idea of progress and he loved the American family. He himself was probably as American as anyone could possibly be. He thought it would be fun to watch the American family go through the twentieth century experiencing all new wonders as they came. And he put them together in a show called Carousel of Progress, which we are about to see. Although our Carousel family has experienced a few changes over the years, our show still revolves around the same theme: and that's progress. May the century begin.

CHORUS

*There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Shining at the end of every day
There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
And tomorrow is just a dream away
Man has a dream and that's the start
He follows his dream in mind and heart*

Part 1: 1900s

(John is sitting at the table of his 1890s-early 1900s kitchen, holding a newspaper.)

JOHN (JEAN SHEPHERD)

*And when it becomes a reality
It's a dream come true for you and me
So there's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Shining at the end of every day
There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Just a dream away*

(birds chirp outside)

Well, looks like the robins are getting ready to celebrate Valentine's Day today. What year is

it? Oh, right around the turn of the century. And things couldn't be any better than they are today. Yes sir, buildings are towering now as high as twenty stories. And moving pictures flicker up on a big screen. We have almost eight thousand automobiles in this country, and we can travel by train from New York to California in less than seven days! And I even hear tell of two brothers from North Carolina who are working on some kind of flying contraption. (*chuckles*) It'll never work.

(The appliances turn on and off as he talks about them.)

Closer to home, we've now got gas lamps, telephone, and the latest design in cast iron stoves. And that reservoir keeps five gallons of water hot all day on just three buckets of coal. Oh boy, it sure beats chopping wood. And isn't our new icebox a beauty? Look at that! Holds fifty pounds of ice. Milk doesn't sour as quick as it used to, and our dog Rover here keeps the water in the drip pan from overflowing. It wasn't too long ago that we had to carry water from a well. Thanks to progress, we have a pump right here in the kitchen. The pump handle magically moves and water starts to flow. Of course, we keep a bucket of water handy to prime it with. Yes sir, we've got everything to make life easier. Say, mother?

(Mother Sarah is ironing clothes in the room to the left, as a girl is washing them.)

SARAH (B.J. WARD)

Hmm?

JOHN

I was reading about a fellow named Tom Edison who's working on an idea for a snap-on electric light.

SARAH

Electric lights? No more kerosene! No more gas!

JOHN

(chuckles) Sarah sure gets to the core of the apple.

SARAH

But we do have this new washday marvel. It takes only five hours to do the wash. Imagine! It used to take two days.

JOHN

That's right, folks. Now Mother has time for other things, like...

SARAH

Like canning and cleaning the oven?

JOHN

Yes, dear.

SARAH

Well, ovens just don't clean themselves, you know.

JOHN

I know, dear. (*chuckles*) And they probably never will!

SARAH

Now, if you'll excuse me, I've got to get the laundry off the line before it starts raining cats and dogs.

ROVER

(*barks*)

JOHN

Ah, don't worry, Rover. She didn't mean real dogs. Besides, it's not going to rain today. My lumbago isn't acting up.

(*Suddenly, a thunderstorm starts.*)

SARAH

I hate to say I told you so.

JOHN

Oh, look at it come down! All you have to do is put your wash on the line, right? Oh well, the cistern was low anyway.

(*In the room to the right, Jimmy is trying out a stereoscope.*)

JIMMY (PETER NELSON)

Wowee! Look at that!

JOHN

Now James, I though I told you to ask my permission before using my new stereoscope. That's not a toy, you know!

JIMMY

Ooh la la! So that's the Norwegian doing the hoochie-koochie, eh dad?

JOHN

Isn't she a knockout? She's the star of the new World's Fair in Saint Louis and... ahem...you put that away before your mother finds it.

JIMMY

Aw, dad...

JOHN

You heard me! Well, we have one of those new talking machines...now that is something. It plays music right here in our home.

(The radio in the next room plays the theme song. Grandma sits nearby, sound asleep.)

PARROT

(squawks) She keeps that thing going all day long. *(squawks)* Progress!

(In another room, Patricia sits at her vanity in her [absurdly modest by today's standards] underwear, brushing her hair.)

PATRICIA (DEBI DERRYBERRY)

Oh, Papa.

JOHN

Yes, Patricia?

PATRICIA

Papa! All these people! I'm...I'm indecent!

JOHN

(chuckles) Don't worry, Patricia. They're friends. That's my teenage daughter. She's getting

ready to go to a Valentine's dance across town, on one of those new horseless trolleys.

PATRICIA

I think it's very romantic you're taking mother out for Valentine's dinner this evening.

JOHN

Well, you know what kind of sport I am.

PATRICIA

I only hope I have an evening as romantic as yours and mothers.

JOHN

Now, you be home by nine o'clock, daughter. You hear me?

PATRICIA

Yes, Papa...

JOHN

(sigh) Well, with all this talking, I've worked up quite a thirst. I think I'll take one of those new fangled trolleys down to the drug store soda fountain and meet the boys for a cold sarsaparilla. Oh...haha, I'm sorry, I forgot...we're drinking root beer now! Same kind of thing, different name. Well, that's progress for you. And, uh, speaking of progress...

*There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Shining at the end of every day
There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
And tomorrow is just a dream away
Man has a dream and that's the start
He follows his dream in mind and heart*

Part 2: 1920s

*And when it becomes a reality
It's a dream come true for you and me
So there's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Shining at the end of every day
There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Just a dream away*

(John is in a 1920's kitchen, holding a souvenir fan from Niagara Falls, a pitcher and glass of iced tea in front of him.)

Whew, boy! Hottest Fourth of July we've had in years. We've come a long way, though, since the turn of the century over twenty-some odd years ago. You know that pilot fella...Charles Lindberg? He's about to fly a single winged airplane all the way across the Atlantic.

(chuckles) He's never gonna make it. And sports stadiums are springing up all over. And boy...nobody hits that old horse hide like that new fella, Babe Ruth. Jazz music is the cat's meow, and there's been ads in the paper for months for a movie starring Al Jolson...

(whispers) and he's going to talk! And sing! Boy, I've got to see that.

(a klaxon horn is heard outside)

(laughs) There goes Schwartz in his humpmobile. He sure loves that horn. You know, in my new Essex, I've got an electric starter! Now I don't have to crank. We can travel from New York to Los Angeles by train in only three days. And we've got a house full of new electrical servants. Mr. Edison sure added life to our home.

(The appliances show off their power.)

Whoa there! You'll blow a fuse!

(The lights go out.)

Drat! That's the third one this week. I buy fuses by the case.

(The entire stage goes dark.)

Uh oh. And I've blown the whole neighborhood again!

NEIGHBOR

Henry! He did it again! Go over and give that neighbor of ours what for!

ROVER

(growls)

JOHN

Easy, Rover. Jimmy! Hurry up with that fuse!

(Jimmy is heard walking across the room.)

JIMMY

Shucks. Every time he has company, he blows a fuse. And guess who always has to change it.

JOHN

I heard that, young man! I heard that!

(The power comes back on. Sarah is in the room to the right in colonial costume, sewing. The room is decorated patriotically.)

SARAH

Oh, well, that's more like it. John, yours is the last costume I've got to finish before the parade starts.

JOHN

Sarah's lady's club is responsible for our town's Fourth of July celebration tonight. She's got us all roped into performing in their program, and I...

SARAH

And I've decided that we're going as George and Martha Washington, dear.

JOHN

Oh, the father of our country. *(chuckles)* That's a role that really fits me! You know, I--

SARAH

I'm so glad that we installed an electric light fixture here on the porch, because it's just too darn hot to be sewing inside.

JOHN

Yes, Sarah. You know, next year I'd like to go as Benedict Arnold! *(laughs)*

SARAH

Wait until you see what I've got planned for the fireworks show tonight.

ROVER

(barks)

JOHN

Rover! Don't interrupt while Sarah's interrupting.

SARAH

And guess who volunteered to choose the music for the program.

JIMMY

I did, Pop! Listen to this!

(In the left room, Jimmy plays Stars and Stripes Forever on a record player. Grandpa sits nearby.)

JOHN

Oh...that's a nice tune, Jimmy. You know, with our new Gladstone radio set, we can get news and big-time entertainment from all over the country - even Pittsburgh!

RADIO ANNOUNCER (NOEL BLANC)

People are starting to arrive downtown for a spectacular Fourth of July parade and fireworks event tonight. Mayor Beaverfield said...

JOHN

Oh, Patricia.

PATRICIA

Yes, Father?

JOHN

Better get a move on. The radio says people are arriving downtown.

PATRICIA

Do I really have to go?

(Patricia is in her bedroom - newly decorated with high school memorabilia - dressed as the Statue of Liberty.)

If my new boyfriend Theodore sees me in this, it'll scare him away!

JOHN

(chuckles) Well, dear, if that happens, you'll always have that torch you can carry for him.
(laughs)

ROVER

(growls)

PATRICIA

Oh, father!

JOHN

Oh, calm down, Rover. I was only kidding. By the way, we have indoor plumbing now! Oh boy, that's really great on cold nights. Especially for our perennial house guest, old Uncle Orville.

(Orville is in the tub reading a magazine, his Uncle Sam Costume hanging on the wall, a fan on a stool nearby.)

Uncle Orville's taken over the coolest spot in the house. And he's rigged up a real clever contraction. He calls it "air cooling." Hmph. Too bad he's not reading the help wanted ads.

UNCLE ORVILLE (MEL BLANC)

No privacy at all around this place!

JOHN

Sorry, Orville. You know, considering all the...

SARAH

John. Costume's ready.

JOHN

Oh! Coming, Martha. As I was saying, considering all the conveniences we now have, I'd say that we're really on easy street these days. It just can't get any better! Just goes to show that...

*There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Shining at the end of every day*

*There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
And tomorrow is just a dream away
Man has a dream and that's the start
He follows his dream in mind and heart*

Part 3: 1940s

*And when it becomes a reality,
It's a dream come true for you and me.
So there's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Shining at the end of every day.
There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Just a dream away*

(John is sitting at the table of a mid-century-modern kitchen. It's autumn; a jack-o-lantern sits on the table.)

Well, it's another Halloween here in the Fabulous Forties. Everything is better than ever now. And we've got some amazing new wonders around the house to prove it. For instance, our refrigerator hold more food than ice cubes. And thanks to our new automatic dishwasher, I don't have to dry the dishes anymore after supper. Gives Rover and I more time to enjoy our evening stroll together.

ROVER

(barks)

JOHN

(chuckles) Later, boy. Oh, and here's something else that's new. I just heard a new term today on the radio. Fellow says we've got something now called the 'rat race.' Did you ever hear that one? It sure describes my life. I'm involved with something now called commuting. I drive into the city for work all day, and then turn right around and drive all the way back. And the highway is crowded with fellow rats doing the same thing!

SARAH

That's what they call progress, dear.

JOHN

(laughs) I guess she's right. But we do have television...when it works. Gives you something to do after you get home. I kind of like it, you know? A guy named John Cameron Swayze

gives us all the news, and then they have all this singing and dancing. A lot of fluff, but it's fun.

(Grandma is fiddling with the television in the room to the right. Grandpa has fallen asleep.)

GRANDPA

(snores)

JOHN

You know, I predict that day that millions of people will learn Latin and Greek sitting in front of their TV sets.

GRANDMA (MARY CERVANTES)

Are you awake, dear?

GRANDPA

(continues snoring)

(She changes the channel to boxing.)

GRANDMA

Give him a left, you big lug!

JOHN

Ah, yes, a new age of electronic civilization is upon us!

(Jimmy is dressed as a werewolf, working on his jack-o-lantern in his room to the left.)

JIMMY

Hey Dad, what do you think of my jack-o-lantern?

JOHN

Oh! Boy, is that scary!

JIMMY

That's 'cause I used my beautiful sister Patty's picture for a model! *(laughs)*

ROVER

(barks)

JOHN

Down, Rover. Jim, Rover appreciates your joke.

SARAH

Now...you're always kidding poor Patty. She's certainly prettier than either of you.

JIMMY

(howls)

ROVER

(howls)

JOHN

You hear that? My daughter Patty is using that old exercise machine she rescued from the attic. It was all the rage in the twenties. Grandma, of course, had to have one. Didn't work then, doesn't work now. *(chuckles)* Consistent, at least. Makes a lot of noise and blows fuses.

(Patricia's in her room with the ridiculous vibrating contraption around her waist.)

PATRICIA

(voice vibrating) As I was saying, Babs, I think college is really swell. You should give it a try.

BABS

Oh, Patty, are you going to the Halloween party tonight?

PATRICIA

Oh, yes. And I'm hoping to lose a few more inches by then, since I'm going with that dreamboat, Wilfred.

BABS

Wilfred? What a slug!

PATRICIA

He's coming as the headless horseman.

BABS

I think it fits.

PATRICIA

Come on, Babs! That clodhopper Howard you're going with is no Cracker Jack prize!

JOHN

Oh, poor Howard. I wonder what they said about me when I was dating Sarah.

(The cuckoo clock on the wall goes off.)

ROVER

(barks)

JOHN

(chuckles) You're lucky, Rover. You don't have to date.

ROVER

(barks)

JOHN

Well, we're caught up in the do-it-yourself craze these days. We're remodeling our basement as something called a...a rumpus room. And we're looking forward to a few rumpuses, I'll tell you, as long as they don't get out of hand.

(Sarah is busy renovating.)

SARAH

John, this papering is getting out of hand. I could use a little help.

JOHN

Now Sarah, didn't I set up that clever automatic paint stirring machine for you?

(The kitchen mixer stirs paint for her.)

SARAH

Yes, John, you're a genius. Of course, this will ruin my food mixer...not that you'd care.

JOHN

Oh, good old Sarah. Always the last laugh.

(The mixer starts to spin out of control. A splat is heard. Sarah yelps.)

What happened, Sarah?

SARAH

Oh, you and your progress! That paint mixer of yours just sloshed paint across my rump...er, rumpus...room.

JOHN

(laughs) How do you like that? I always say, if you're gonna married, marry a girl with a sense of humor. Well, it's time to move on. Let's cheer up Sarah by singing our song. Come on. Everybody!

*There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Shining at the end of every day
There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
And tomorrow is just a dream away
---*

Part 4: Modern day (mid-1990s)

(The family is together in the living room celebrating Christmas - John at the kitchen, Sarah on her laptop, Jimmy and Grandma playing video games, Patricia admiring her new snow boots.)

WHOLE FAMILY

*Man has a dream and that's the start
He follows his dream in mind and heart
And when it becomes a reality
It's a dream come true for you and me
So there's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Shining at the end of every day
There's a great big beautiful tomorrow
Just a dream away*

JOHN

Isn't it a pleasant holiday? Turkey's in the oven, it's peaceful and quiet...

JIMMY (PAUL OSTERHOUT)

Yes! Three hundred points, my best score yet!

SARAH

Well, it was peaceful until Santa brought that new virtual reality space pilot game.

JIMMY

Your turn, Grandma. Let's switch the image over to the TV, so the resident flying ace can show you how it works. Now, it's a little tricky. Just use your game glove to fly behind the other guy, and then blast him with your laser blaster!

GRANDMA (JANET WALDO)

Laser blaster? Well, I'll give it a try.

JIMMY

Take a look around, Grandma. You're in the ship.

GRANDMA

It feels like I'm really there!

JIMMY

Okay, get ready. You're about to blast off.

GRANDMA

Here goes nothing.

JIMMY

All right, here he comes. Ooh, you missed him.

SARAH

Hey, everyone, I'm done programming our new voice activation system.

JOHN

Now all our household items will do anything we tell them to do.

GRANDPA (REX ALLEN)

Great. Tell the refrigerator to bring me a root beer.

SARAH

(chuckles) Well, it can't quite do that. But I'll show you something that it *can* do. Tree lights, thirty percent brighter.

(The lights on the Christmas tree brighten.)

PATRICIA

Wow!

GRANDPA

Ah, that's no big deal. Anybody can do that voice activating stuff. Watch this. Rover, speak!

ROVER

(barks)

SARAH

John, the oven should respond to your voice commands now. Give it a try.

JOHN

Okay, here goes. Temperature to 375.

OVEN

Temperature increased to 375.

PATRICIA

Look at that! It even talks back.

JOHN

Like some people I know.

PATRICIA

Yeah, right, Dad!

JIMMY

You're going to lose him, Grandma! Bank to the right!

PATRICIA

Remember dad's turkey last year? *(laughs)*

GRANDPA

Yeah, that thing really smoked up the place when it burned, didn't it?

PATRICIA

We ended up microwaving frozen pizzas.

SARAH

Well, no need to worry about the turkey this year. Not with an oven that will do anything your father tells it to do.

JIMMY

Ooh! Good shot!

GRANDMA

Did you see that?!

JIMMY

Dad, Grandma's up to 550 points!

JOHN

Did you say 550? Man, she's getting the hang of that thing.

OVEN

Temperature increased to 550.

GRANDPA

I can't believe all the new gadgets they've got now. Did you know in my day...

PATRICIA

Oh, no. You're not going to tell us about the old days when you didn't even have a car phone.

GRANDPA

(*chuckles*) Hey Trish, for a while, we didn't even have a house phone. Not to mention laserdiscs and high-def TV. Everything is automated these days, including...

(*The toilet flushes.*)

Well, including that.

UNCLE ORVILLE

No privacy at all around this place!

GRANDPA

Sorry, Orville. Anyway, you guys don't realize how good you've got it nowadays.

SARAH

You know, my grandfather told me the very same thing when I was a kid.

GRANDMA

Take that, you nincompoop!

JIMMY

Hey, check it out, Dad. Grandma's up to 975 points.

JOHN

Wow! 975!

OVEN

Temperature increased to 975. *(beeps)* Overload...overload...

SARAH

John, what's wrong with the oven?

JOHN

What? Uh...

(The oven pops open, smoke bellowing outwards.)

OVEN

Bake Mode complete. Enjoy your meal.

PATRICIA

(chuckles) Anyone for pizza?

SARAH

Oh...another Christmas turkey ruined.

GRANDMA

Man, what a game! I really smoked those guys. Looks like I'm resident flying ace now.

JIMMY

Best two out of three, Grandma?

GRANDMA

Later, kid. Boy, that was fun. What will they think up next?

PATRICIA

Who knows? We've got a whole new century waiting for us out there.

SARAH

Yeah, and maybe some time in the new century, your father will learn how to talk to our oven.

FATHER

Well, maybe by then, ovens will read out minds. But hey, as long as we're all here and happy and together for the holidays, who cares if I burned out Christmas turkey?

GRANDMA

I do! I'm starving.

FAMILY

(laughs)

JIMMY

Don't worry, Dad. Someday, everything's gonna be so automated, you won't ever have to cook another Christmas turkey again.

ROVER

(barks)

FAMILY

(laughs)

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Epilogue

NARRATOR

Thank you for joining us on Walt Disney's Carousel of Progress. We hope you've enjoyed this tribute to the 1964 Carousel of Progress from the New York World's Fair. Please gather all your personal belongings and exit through the doors located at the back of the theater. Have a great big beautiful day, and remember: tomorrow is just a dream away.